Assessment of spelling, punctuation and the accurate use of grammar:

Band	Performance descriptions
High performance 5–6 marks	• Learners spell and punctuate with consistent accuracy • Learners use rules of grammar with effective control of meaning overall
Intermediate performance 3–4 marks	• Learners spell and punctuate with considerable accuracy • Learners use rules of grammar with general control of meaning overall
Threshold performance 1–2 marks	• Learners spell and punctuate with reasonable accuracy • Learners use rules of grammar with some control of meaning and any errors do not significantly hinder meaning overall
0	• The learner writes nothing • The learner's response does not relate to the question • The learner's achievement in SPaG does not reach the threshold performance Band, for example errors in spelling, punctuation and grammar severely hinder meaning